PDQ: the week in numbers

4 October 2026. Nada.

	before	after
wrong answers (125 clips)	7	**1**
correct answers	52	48
mirrored clips identified	0 of 8	**8 of 8**
letterboxed clips identified	1 of 8	**6 of 8**

1. What was working before

- The pod's engine, as an exact laptop copy. 52 of 125 known clips right, 7 wrong.
- Three parts can answer, in order: pre-scan, probe (P0), then the rules.

decider	evidence it needs	checks offsets?	share of answers
pre-scan	3 frames, best under 20	no	most
probe P0	1 frame under 30	no	some
rules P1-P9	1 to 30 frames by rule	only the mid rules	the rest

2. How it was working

- The quick parts decide most clips on counting alone. The careful checks sit in rules that rarely decide.
- A true match gives the same offset (film time minus clip time) for every frame. Nothing that decides most of the traffic checks this.
- Every answer now records the rule that made it. The seven wrong answers:

rule	wrong answers	distance
pre-scan	4 (Krrish 3, Northman, Civil War, In Between)	6 - 18
P0 probe	1 (Smile)	26.8
P9E	1 (Grave Encounters 2)	34.0
P8	1 (Demeter)	41.4

```
PS C:\Users\nadaa\pdq_for_nada> python attribute_rules.py --engine pdq_engine_ORIGINAL.py

================================================================================
  WHICH RULE PRODUCED THE ANSWERS   (engine: pdq_engine_ORIGINAL.py)
================================================================================

  WRONG answers reproduced (these rules are the problem): 7
     SCAN       4
     P0         1
     P9E        1
     P8         1
       SCAN       Krrish 3                          avg=6.0 frames=27
       P0         Smile                             avg=26.8 frames=5
       SCAN       Captain America: Civil War        avg=12.0 frames=4
       P9E        Grave Encounters 2                avg=34.0 frames=2
       SCAN       The In Between                    avg=18.0 frames=4
       SCAN       The Northman                      avg=6.0 frames=6
       P8         The Last Voyage of the Demeter    avg=41.4 frames=31

  CORRECT answers (these rules must keep working): 52
     SCAN       46
     P0         3
     P3.5       2
     P1         1
```

• Four of seven come from the pre-scan. Rule changes can never reach them.

3. What I built

• **Attribution testing**: every answer tagged with the rule that produced it.

• **A rebuilt probe**: whole-clip view + the careful checks, as one decider.

• **An edits test**: 10 reposter edits x 8 clips that work unedited.

• **Two fixes**: mirrored views, and cutting black bars before fingerprinting.

4. How the new probe works

• Samples 40 frames across the whole clip; keeps a scorecard per film: frames, best distance, and every hit's (clip time, film time) pair.

• Answers only when the evidence agrees like a real scene does:

bar	needs	copied from
PV-A	2 near-identical frames	P2.5
PV-B	3 frames, best under 20, 2 agreeing on offset	pre-scan + P4
PV-C	5 medium frames agreeing, from 2 clip moments	P6a

• The one-frame P0 is retired. The rules stay behind it as backup.

5. Results

Real clips, all 125:

engine	wrong	correct
pod's rules	7	52
new probe alone	1	41
new probe + rules backup	**1**	**48**

```
PS C:\Users\nadaa\pdq_for_nada> python attribute_rules.py --engine pdq_engine_PROBEV2.py

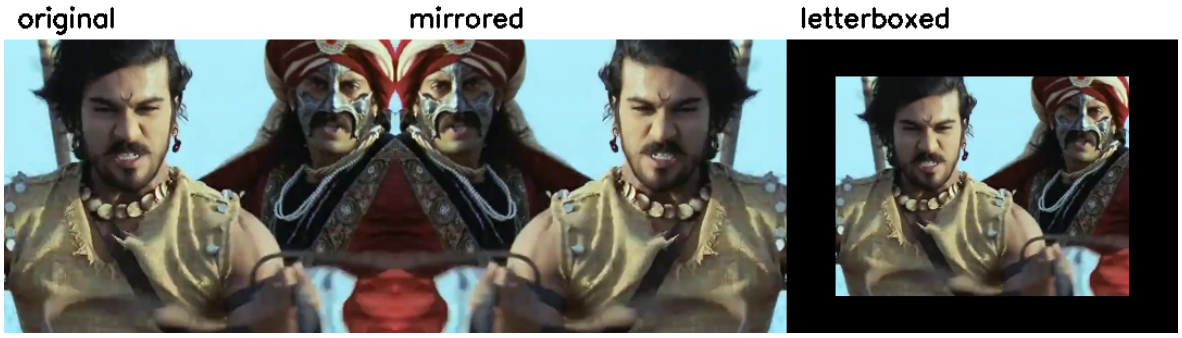
================================================================================
  WHICH RULE PRODUCED THE ANSWERS   (engine: pdq_engine_PROBEV2.py)
================================================================================

  WRONG answers reproduced (these rules are the problem): 1
     PV-A       1
       PV-A       Krrish 3                          avg=6.0 frames=16

  CORRECT answers (these rules must keep working): 48
     PV-A       22
     PV-B       17
     P1         4
     P3.5       3
     PV-C       2
```

- The 1 left: Krrish 3, distance 6, identical pictures. Needs audio / SSCD.
- The 4 lost: fan edits that jump scenes. Recovering them readmits 2 wrongs. Kept strict.

Edited clips:



edit	before	after
mirror	0 of 8	**8 of 8** (distance 2)
letterbox	1 of 8	**6 of 8**
filter / b&w / recompress / speeds	6-8 of 8	unchanged

- No edit ever produced a wrong film, on any version. Edits silence, never fool.
- Safety gate: all 125 real clips re-run with the fixes. Zero answers changed.
- Cost: probe 4x slower with extra views. Pod shape: normal views first.

The asks

1. Policy call: the 4 fan-edit clips. I recommend staying strict.
2. Someone watches the Misfits clip (both engines say F1, distance 8).
3. Direction: take the probe towards the pod? Next step: normal-views-first at pod scale.
4. Still open: keep clip_query_hashes rows for voted clips. Clips are still rotting.